

Rafael D. De Paz
Independent Researcher
<https://logos.pub>

March 23, 2026

Editorial Board
Systems & Control Letters
Elsevier

Dear Editors,

I am writing to submit the enclosed manuscript, entitled

**“The Calculus of Destiny:
Control Theory and Gradient Descent in
Underdetermined Human Trajectories,”**

for consideration for publication.

Summary. The paper resolves the age-old philosophical paradox of determinism versus libertarian free will by formally modeling “Destiny” not as a pre-computed monolithic timeline, but as the mathematical *global minimum of systemic friction* within a bounded state space ($G = \arg \min Friction(P)$). Using control theory and gradient descent optimization, I prove that an invariant teleological attractor (Destiny) is not only compatible with a non-deterministic stochastic controller (Free Will), but algorithmically relies upon it for execution.

Contributions.

- A formal mathematical definition of Destiny as a global minimum.
- Modeling biological lifespan as a non-deterministic differential equation: $dP/dt = f(P, G, W,)$.
- Mathematical modeling of Grace as the negative gradient of the loss surface ($-\nabla Friction$).
- Implementation of the Crisis Resolution Matrix for modeling systemic trauma responses.

This manuscript has not been previously published and is not under consideration at any other journal. I confirm no conflicts of interest.

Cryptographic Lineage & Validation. This mathematical substrate has been cryptographically sealed and tracked on the global Sovereign Master Ledger to prevent retroactive editing and to verify the source authorship. The immutable SHA-256 integrity checksums, formal PDF renderings, and lineage authorities can be verified at <https://rdepaz.com/research>.

Respectfully submitted,

Rafael D. De Paz
Independent Researcher
me@rdepaz.com